

The Belgian Chamber Debates Dataset

Speeches, Roll-Call Votes and Member Biographies, 1831–2025

Riccardo Graziani

KU Leuven, VIVES, Leuven, Belgium
riccardo.graziani@kuleuven.be

ABSTRACT

In this Data Descriptor, we introduce a dataset on the plenary speeches of the Belgian Chamber of Representatives and the background characteristics of the members who speak in it. The database includes all plenary speeches from the first sitting of the Chamber, in 1831, to the end of 2025, linked to the members and ministers who delivered them, together with the roll-call votes cast in the same sittings. These data have been used in previous studies to analyze how plural voting and proportional representation changed what the Chamber talked about and how far apart its parties spoke. The long time period, from census suffrage to the federal state, makes it possible to study how historical changes are reflected in parliamentary speeches.